



FREE GUIDE · FOR PAIN MANAGEMENT

The Pain Management Clinic's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Controlled substances are the whole game —
here's how to handle them, and every stream.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Controlled substances, under scrutiny.

Pain management clinics handle controlled substances more than almost any outpatient setting — opioids and sedatives, plus procedure sharps from injections and nerve blocks. The DEA watches this specialty closely, so non-retrievable destruction and a clean wasting trail aren't optional. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

As a DEA-registered destruction company we handle your controlled and non-controlled waste non-retrievable, with Form 41 and witnessed logs, and a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Your defining stream — Schedule II–V opioids and sedatives, expired and wasted.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V drugs
- Wasted & partial doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, complete a DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, keep witnessed waste logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance / medication mail-back kit, to DEA standards.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Injection and procedure sharps — epidurals, nerve blocks, joint injections.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Injection & procedure needles
- Epidural & nerve-block sharps
- Syringes

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 03

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired non-controlled medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled Rx
- Non-controlled injectables
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 04

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Procedure and injection-site waste.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked gauze
- Contaminated PPE
- Procedure waste

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The pain management compliance checklist.

- ☐ Controlled substances logged, wasted doses witnessed, rendered non-retrievable with Form 41.
- ☐ A clean, auditable controlled-substance paper trail (the DEA scrutinizes this specialty).
- ☐ Procedure and injection sharps in FDA-cleared containers.

- ☐ Expired non-controlled meds destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS PAIN CLINICS ASK

Your pain management questions, answered.

How do we dispose of expired or wasted opioids?

Rendered non-retrievable through a DEA-compliant method with a Form 41 and witnessed waste logs — never trashed or flushed. This is the area the DEA examines most in pain management.

What documentation do we need for the DEA?

Witnessed wasting logs plus Certificates of Destruction and Form 41 keep your controlled records audit-ready.

Are procedure sharps handled like any sharps?

Yes — epidural, nerve-block, and injection sharps go in an FDA-cleared sharps container and a sharps mail-back kit.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits sized to a pain management clinic — controlled and non-controlled meds plus procedure sharps — destroyed non-retrievable at our DEA-registered facility, with Form 41 and a Certificate of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Opioids / controlled substances	Controlled destruction (Form 41, wasting logs)
Procedure & injection sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Expired non-controlled meds	Pharmaceutical waste kit

Waste stream

The right path

Procedure biohazard

Biohazard mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back suits most pain clinics. Higher volume or multiple sites? We'll size a program — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY PAIN MANAGEMENT CLINICS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your pain management clinic waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop